

KYLE GAARDER

GTM Leader | New Products | Community & Network Growth

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SUMMARY

GTM operator and product builder with a track record of 0-1 product launches and community-driven network growth. I build trust-based networks from scratch - designing activation systems, member referral loops, and programs that convert engagement into durable retention. My background spans marketplace GTM, coliving, and market creation. I thrive in ambiguous environments, run rapid experiments across teams, and turn ambitious product bets into scalable real-world growth systems.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

- 📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX
- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching
 - 100% occupancy before lease start
 - Designed onboarding, activation, and community loop systems
 - driving 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
 - Built and tested member referral and ambassador programs -
 - community-led acquisition became primary growth channel
 - Ran 48 community dinners, 4 mastermind cohorts, and 6
 - work-trade programs, building engagement and retention
 - Executed A/B testing on dynamic pricing and stay-length
 - diversification, generating a 48% annual revenue lift at 94% occupancy
 - Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY.
 - Facilitated smooth acquisition transition to Macro House
- Built member insights engine via interviews and events,
- synthesizing patterns into GTM and product recommendations

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

- 📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR
- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots
 - community outreach and concept validation
 - Ran 48 structured customer discovery interviews guiding GTM
 - positioning and go-to-market sequencing
 - Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an
 - investor-backed pilot program
 - Led cross-functional execution across strategy, ops, brand, and
 - product in a pre-launch startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

- 📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA
- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
 - Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
 - Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
 - Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
 - Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 💎 **Circles GTM Launch - DRI Ready**
Build end-to-end GTM motions for trust-based networks - activation loops, referral programs, community nurture
- 💎 **48% Revenue Lift via Experimentation**
A/B tested pricing and engagement programs, drove 48% annual revenue growth at sustained occupancy
- 💎 **Rapid Network Launch**
Launched and filled 8-bed network in 2 weeks, sustained 94% occupancy for 19 months
- 💎 **Investor Pilot Secured**
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community network concept across 5 states
- 💎 **Demand Pipeline Built**
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

- GTM Strategy & Launch
- Community-Led Growth
- Cross-Functional Execution
- Channel Experimentation
- Member Activation Onboarding
- Lifecycle & Nurture Programs
- Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

- Bachelors in Science, Biology
- Virginia Tech
- 08/2010 - 05/2014
- Virginia, USA
- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish
- GPA
3.5 / 4.0